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## X CEO Linda Yaccarino steps down from the company

By [Michael Bodley](#)

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[X](#) CEO Linda Yaccarino, in an unexpected move, said on Wednesday that she's stepping down, capping off a turbulent two-year period for the social media business.

Yaccarino's announcement comes just months after [Elon Musk's xAI acquired X](#) in March. The all-cash acquisition resulted in a fresh valuation of \$80 billion for xAI and \$33 billion for X. And the merger solidified [Musk's push to deploy AI](#) across his companies.

Following news of her departure, [xAI's debt continued to see its prices slide](#), according to PitchBook LCD. Investors had already balked at the lack of transparency around business financials during the company's recent bond sale.

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Yaccarino's exit also hits in the middle of a high-profile hiring frenzy for AI jobs across big tech companies. Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg has in the first half of 2025 lured away key OpenAI personnel, and his publicly traded company [just shelled out \\$14 billion](#) for a 49% stake in startup Scale AI.

Yaccarino noted that X's "historic business turn around we have accomplished together has been nothing short of remarkable," in a [post](#) on the social network. Musk acquired the company for \$44 billion in 2022, then [the largest take-private deal since 2016](#), and quickly slashed headcount.

She also praised Musk's ambitions to make X an "everything app," including plans to incorporate native payments on the social media site. The company recently hired entrepreneur Nikita Bier as its head of product.

There was no immediate word on her successor or her plans.

*Update: Additional context about xAI's debt has been added. (July 9, 2025)*

*Featured image by Alex Wong/Getty Images*

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About [Michael Bodley](#)

Michael Bodley is a senior venture capital reporter at PitchBook News, covering top fund managers and developments affecting limited partners. Based in New York, Michael previously led TheStreet.com's crypto coverage. He also reported for Hedge Fund Alert after breaking into journalism at the San Francisco Chronicle. Originally from Baltimore, Michael graduated from Elon University.

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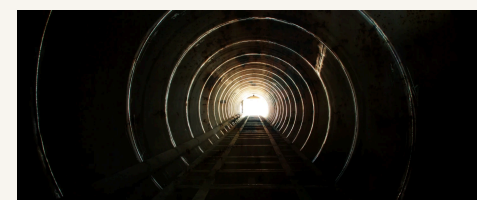
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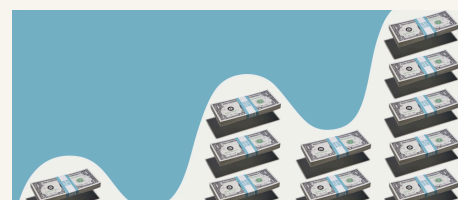


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